

apps that made it fun for everyone? You couldn't quite say with certainty, but Apple had cast a spell. The smartphone industry or even human-computer interaction on a broader scale, was never the same again. In its characteristic way of subtle and oblique publicity, Apple aired the first advertisement for iPhone during the Academy Awards that year, with a series of images of actors saying hello into telephone receivers and ending with a shot of iPhone and the subtext "Hello. Coming in June". The ad was efficient and straight forward, just like the product, which went on to be named Invention of the Year by Time Magazine. Priced initially at \$599 for the 8GB version and \$499 for the 4GB model, sales took off immediately. In fact, the demand was so high that AP reported in 2007 that some users were unable to activate their phones because as per AT&T, the fixed service provider, "high volume of activation requests was taxing the company's computer servers". These prices were soon slashed down, by as much as a third, and the demand kept increasing.

So what made the iPhone click, and how did it revolutionize people and their interaction with personal gadgets forever? Firstly, the technology might not have been exceptionally original but the packaging definitely was. Apart from Steve Jobs, British industrial designer Jonathan Ive, is to be credited for most of the design appeal, for which he received praises all around the world, eventually earning him honorary doctorates from premier schools like RISD and Royal College of Art and the ultimate Briton honor, a knighthood in 2012. What started as translucent, multi-colored iMacs, under Ive made way for the minimalistic consumer design of the iPhone and popularized some key aesthetic traits like a single home button on the entire product apart from the screen. As per the standards of those days, it was almost an anorexic device clocking in at only 11.6 mm width, and despite the touch interface, to its amazing portability delighted the public. And while people were still getting used to their touch phone, came Apple's next offering – the iPod Touch. Apple had thus laid the groundwork for its touch screen gadgets combo of iPhone, iPod and the soon to come iPad.

The iPhone touched the million units mark within months of its launch, and by 2012 with four different models till date – the original iPhone, iPhone 3G, iPhone 3GS and iPhone 4 – the collective sales are soon expected to touch 200 million. The figures in themselves cannot be contributed to a single factor as such, but apart from the aesthetic design, the other most appealing factor was the large world of apps it opened up. This remained